

MEGHNA YADAV

PhD Candidate, New York University

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EDUCATION

New York University PhD in Political Science	<i>2021 - ongoing</i>
Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi Master of Arts in Economics	<i>2015 - 2017</i>
Shri Ram College of Commerce, University of Delhi Bachelor of Arts (Honours) in Economics	<i>2012 - 2015</i>

WORKING PAPERS & WORKS IN PROGRESS

- “Bureaucrat Tenure and Use of Local Knowledge: Evidence from rural development officials in India”
- “Bureaucratic Discretion and Assignment: Evidence from Forest Rights in India”
- “Party Alignment and Investment in Legibility by Local Governments: Evidence from ‘Mission Antyodaya’”
- “Downstream Effects of Women’s Representation: Caste and Gender in India’s Political Quotas”

GRANTS / AWARDS

- NSF-APSA Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant: 2025
- Identities and Ideologies Research Grant (New York University): 2024
- George Downs Prize (New York University): 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
- MacCracken Fellowship (New York University): 2021 - ongoing
- Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure Fellowship: 2021

CONFERENCES

- London School of Economics Political Economy Conference: 2026
- Pre-APSA South Asia Political Economy of Development Workshop (Harvard University): 2026 (*upcoming*)
- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting: 2024, 2025, 2026 (*upcoming*)
- Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting: 2026
- Identities and Ideologies Graduate Conference: 2025, 2026
- Empirical Study of Gender Research Annual Meeting: 2024

TEACHING

- *Comparative Politics*, with Prof. Tara Slough, Fall 2025 (TA)
- *Comparative Politics*, with Prof. Gwyneth McClendon, Spring 2025 (TA)
- *Research Methods*, with Prof. Patrick Egan, Fall 2024 (TA)
- *International Politics*, with Prof. Bueno de Mesquita, Spring 2023 and Spring 2024 (TA)
- *Democracy, Knowledge and Equality*, with Prof. Melissa Schwartzberg, Fall 2023 (TA)
- *STATA Workshop*, for Bahujan Economists, Spring 2023 (Instructor)

WORK EXPERIENCE

- Research Associate, Social Networks Lab, J-PAL, 2019 - 2021
 - Studied impact of caste-based political reservations on attitudes and social networks in Bihar, with Prof. Emily Breza (Harvard University), Prof. Arun Chandrasekhar (Stanford University) and Prof. M.R. Sharan (University of Maryland)
- Research Associate, Centre for Development Economics, Delhi School of Economics, 2018 - 2019
 - Studied barriers to take-up of Government- and NGO-provided childcare services and implications for women's work in low accessibility areas with Prof. Rohini Somanathan (Delhi School of Economics)
- Field Survey Team with Prof. Jean Dreze and Prof. Reetika Khera, 2017, 2019, 2020
 - Conducted multiple surveys with Prof. Jean Dreze (Ranchi University) and Prof. Reetika Khera (IIT, Delhi) covering different aspects of social security in India

MEDIA AND POLICY

- Pay ratios and income inequality in India, with Reetika Khera, *Ideas for India*
- “India's COVID-19 lockdown saved lives but wrecked livelihoods”, with Aarushi Kalra, Kanika Sharma and Alamu R., *Scroll*
- Social Security during Covid-19, *Scroll*
- “Even Under Attack, India's Democratic Institutions Are Pushing Back”, *The Wire*

SERVICE

- Steward, Graduate Employees Union at New York University, Spring 2024 - ongoing
- Convenor and Mentor, Bahujan Economists' Mentorship Program for PhD applicants, 2022 - ongoing
- Organizer, Graduate Political Economy Seminar, New York University, Fall 2024
- Discussant, Gender and Political Participation Working Group, Spring 2024

SKILLS

Languages	Hindi, English (native)
Computer	R, Stata, OpenDataKit, LaTeX, ArcGIS, Tableau